

ASTRAZOAN

UNCOMMON

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ABERRATION

Uncommon Access

Astrazoans have the uncommon trait because their identity and Change Shape mechanics require close coordination with the GM, not because astrazoans are rare within the Settled Systems.

Astrazoans claim **Wander** as their home world alongside humans and brenneri. Few records or physical remains survived Wander's loss, and an astrazoan can pass convincingly as many other sapient ancestries, leaving the claim difficult to verify. The earliest surviving pre-PES accounts describe astrazoans revealing their natural bodies only after Wander established contact with other peoples touched by **the Star Dream** and joined the first intersystem exchanges.

Whether astrazoans originated on Wander, arrived there before surviving records began, or later adopted it as their home remains unresolved. Many early astrazoans recorded their lives through borrowed identities and within the traditions of the communities they joined. Their history survives throughout Wander's records, but rarely under names recognized as astrazoan.

An astrazoan's malleable body allows them to assume forms adapted to different environments, occupations, and cultures. Their natural form resembles a human-sized starfish, with five to seven limbs surrounding a bulbous tissue reservoir and a soft, creviced underbelly lined with cilia, bony teeth, and distributed sensory organs.

Most Settled Systems infrastructure has little practical accommodation for this body. Once an astrazoan learns to maintain stable skins, employers, governments, and communities increasingly identify them according to the services those forms can provide. Many astrazoans consequently call their natural form their **unassigned body**: the body that has not yet been shaped for an employer, occupation, relationship, community, or social expectation.

Before Common was standardized, astrazoans were instrumental in communication between the peoples recognized among the Elect. Their ability to reproduce unfamiliar voices, facial movements, gestures, and physical mannerisms allowed them to act as interpreters and cultural intermediaries during the earliest



intersystem exchanges. The pre-PES contact language recorded as **Accommodated-Universal Wander Slant**, commonly shortened to **Wander Slant**, later became one of the foundations of Common under Settled Systems Code **A1%5899-101**.

As biometric authentication became standard throughout the Settled Systems, unexpected deaths, disappearances, and corporate closures sometimes left essential infrastructure locked behind credentials belonging to people who could no longer provide them. Erbium Industries responded by employing astrazoans to assume **remembrances**: carefully reconstructed skins designed to reproduce a person's appearance, voice, movement, and biometric tolerances closely enough to satisfy legacy systems.

Originally presented as an emergency measure, remembrance service became a permanent component of Erbium infrastructure. Some astrazoans now spend years wearing the faces of dead technicians, administrators, and specialists because replacing the systems that recognize them would cost the company more.

If you want to play an outsider who adopts new bodies and identities in search of belonging while navigating a society that measures each form by its usefulness, you should play an astrazoan.

YOU MIGHT...

- ◆ Shift between established identities to approach different situations.
- ◆ Reveal your unassigned body only to people you trust completely.
- ◆ Maintain separate careers, relationships, habits, or obligations through different skins.
- ◆ Resist employers who expect every form you assume to provide a useful service.
- ◆ Carry a remembrance whose original purpose ended long ago.
- ◆ Use a borrowed appearance to enter institutions that would otherwise exclude you.

OTHERS PROBABLY...

- ◆ Envy your shapeshifting and assume the process is painless.
- ◆ Fail to recognize you across your different skins.
- ◆ Suspect you of impersonation or surveillance even when you have done nothing deceptive.
- ◆ Treat your registered identity as more legitimate than your other established selves.
- ◆ Evaluate your bodies according to the labor or access they can provide.
- ◆ Ask invasive questions about your unassigned body, digestion, or transformation.

PHYSICAL DESCRIPTION

An astrazoan can reshape their hyper-flexible body into an enormous range of sapient forms. They redistribute their jellylike tissue, contract or extend their limbs, and pull their organs into new positions using long networks of muscular tendons. Once a transformation is complete, their body maintains the new arrangement

without conscious effort.

The process is swift, physical, and painful. Bones and hardened tissues pop into new alignments, organs shift through the torso, and entire muscle groups stretch or collapse. The transformation also releases a strong surge of endorphins, allowing the astrazoan to remain functional while their body reorganizes itself.

In their unassigned body, an astrazoan is radially symmetrical and possesses five to seven limbs. Spiny crevices along their soft underbelly protect delicate cilia, distributed eyes, digestive openings, and other sensory organs. Their leathery skin is covered in dermal papillae that can alter color, texture, and contour. Young astrazoans develop control over these surface changes long before they can complete a full transformation.

A fleshy reservoir rises from the center of the body. This structure stores tissue that can be redistributed when the astrazoan assumes a larger shape. Some astrazoans incorporate flexible cybernetics into this reservoir or along their nerve networks, allowing compatible augmentations to migrate as their anatomy changes.

Even an astrazoan's digestive organs are mobile. In their unassigned body, they can extend portions of their stomach through a ventral opening to digest food externally before drawing it back inside. Most learn to reorganize their digestive system when assuming another ancestry's form, allowing them to eat in ways considered ordinary within the culture they have joined.

New astrazoans and those who have maintained one body for many years can struggle when developing another skin. These difficulties often repeat across forms. An astrazoan might consistently produce an extra finger on the same hand, place a small eye near the same joint, or reproduce one facial expression incorrectly. Even after correcting the anatomy, they may continue checking the troublesome feature out of habit.

As they mature, many astrazoans develop up to seven recurring selves, each associated with the neural network of one arm. These selves are distinct personas and modes of life, not separate people inhabiting the same body. Each can develop its own appearance, habits, relationships, emotional associations, and experiences, while the astrazoan's broader identity remains a blended plurality composed of all of them.

Mature astrazoans can experiment with temporary forms freely, but most spend the majority of their lives in several established skins associated with these recurring selves. Each skin expresses a genuine part of the astrazoan rather than serving as a costume worn over an otherwise singular identity.



When an astrazoan assumes another ancestry's form, distinguishing them from an ordinary member of that ancestry can be extremely difficult. A thorough medical examination may reveal unusual internal structures, but practiced astrazoans can conceal their nature even from close friends and family.

Once an astrazoan can maintain their first stable skin, the Settled Systems generally become more interested in the services that body can perform than in the anatomy beneath it. Employers register skins for particular assignments, medical systems classify them according to their current form, and acquaintances may never encounter the astrazoan's unassigned body.

Calling the natural form an unassigned body does not make an astrazoan's other identities false. Each established skin can embody real relationships, habits, obligations, and parts of the astrazoan's personality. The unassigned body is simply the form least shaped by external expectations.

SOCIETY

What astrazoans lack in a unified ancestral homeland, they make up for through an extraordinary ability to participate in the cultures and communities of other peoples. Their adaptation extends beyond physical appearance to language, posture, speech patterns, dietary habits, social customs, and behaviors learned through prolonged contact.

Astrazoans played a major role in the first meetings between the peoples of the Elect. They reproduced unfamiliar vocal structures, gestures, expressions, and body language before translators or shared communication standards existed. Many early astrazoan interpreters conducted this work through borrowed forms, causing later histories to credit their contributions to humans, brenneri, or other peoples whose bodies they wore.

Official histories describe the Elect as having overcome their differences through the unity of the Star Dream. Astrazoan accounts place considerably more emphasis on the interpreters, compromises, misunderstandings, and patient labor required to make that unity possible.

Within the modern Settled Systems, an astrazoan's identities are commonly evaluated according to the services they can provide. A skin developed for industrial labor might be valued for its strength or compatibility with standardized machinery. Another might be maintained for negotiation, administration, medical work, public relations, or interaction with a particular ancestry.



Erbium Industries refers to these forms as **service identities**, treating each as an occupational configuration of the same employee. Employment contracts may register particular skins for approved duties, require an astrazoan to maintain specific physical tolerances, or restrict the use of forms associated with controlled access.

Astrazoans do not necessarily share this interpretation. An established skin can carry genuine habits, relationships, preferences, and emotional associations. Although these selves remain facets of one blended astrazoan personality, losing the ability to inhabit one can mean losing an important way of experiencing the world.

Some astrazoans accept formal assignments and build stable careers around one or two commercially useful skins. Others resent being told which bodies they should inhabit and deliberately develop forms with no recognized economic purpose. Remaining in an unassigned body can itself become a quiet refusal to let an employer determine what shape a life should take.

Remembrance service occupies an uneasy position within astrazoan society. Some regard it as essential work that keeps settlements alive and prevents obsolete systems from failing. Others consider it an abusive practice that requires astrazoans to carry the faces and mannerisms of the dead for the convenience of institutions unwilling to replace their infrastructure.

Astrazoans rarely form large ancestry-specific settlements. Their shared practices instead spread through professional networks, private gatherings, family groups, transformation instructors, and informal communities. These networks exchange adaptive clothing patterns, medical knowledge, warnings about ex"The wielding of radiance to elevate the essential aspects of the world"

Domain's suns are actually magical shards that produce light, heat, and Radiance.

The primary radiance's are: yellow radiance (Body/Material), blue radiance (Mind/Cerebral), and red radiance (Spirit/Ethereal).

An elevancer can use their Prismacs to refract their radiance reserves to the respective Tertiary or Secondary radiance.

When an elevancer depletes their radiance reserves, they become dimmed (drained of color), and must rest to restore their reserves.

Elevancy schools: Evoker, Psion, Mystic

Elevancy practioner: Elevancer

Elevancy Prismacs: Spirit, Body, and Mind

Prime Essences: Ethereal, Material, Cerebral

Prime Essential Aspects: Will (Spirit/Ethereal), Inspiration (Spirit/Ethereal), Forces (Body/Material), Elements (Body/Material), Emotion (Mind/Cerebral), and Thought (Mind/Cerebral)

Twin Essential Aspects: Time (Spirit & Body/Ethereal & Material), Fate (Spirit & Mind), and Perception (Body & Mind)ploitative employers, and techniques for maintaining difficult skins.

Many astrazoans form families with members of the communities they join. Others reproduce through budding, producing young who can alter their skin color and texture almost immediately but require years to master complete transformation. Most consider the continuation of their ancestry a personal decision rather than a universal duty, though isolated astrazoans may feel pressure to ensure that their people do not disappear into the cultures around them.

Astrazoans traditionally reveal their unassigned bodies only in private or among people they trust. This secrecy can protect them from suspicion, invasive examinations, compulsory registration, or attempts to exploit their biology. Others reject concealment and use transformation, natural-form dance, and public bodily expression as deliberate acts of visibility.

BELIEFS

Astrazoans have no single religious or philosophical tradition shared across their ancestry. Most adopt the beliefs of the cultures in which they live, though they frequently interpret those traditions through their experiences of bodily transformation and layered identity.

Astrazoans commonly distinguish between deception and sincere identity. A borrowed anatomy can still become an honest expression of the person inhabiting it. An established skin might accumulate relationships, responsibilities, preferences, and memories without becoming separate from the astrazoan's blended self.

Many astrazoans interpret the Star Dream as evidence that continuity does not require permanence. A person can change their body, name, role, culture, or circumstances while remaining connected to their previous experiences. Some believe the revelation was deliberately received through every part of their distributed nervous system. Others reject ancestry-specific interpretations and regard attempts to explain the Dream as another means of assigning purpose to bodies without their consent.

Remembrance service has produced its own religious and ethical disputes. Some communities treat a consensual remembrance as a respectful continuation of a person's service or presence. Others consider the use of a dead person's appearance and voice to be a profound violation, especially when Erbium Industries maintains the imitation for commercial purposes.

Popular Edicts respect the identities through which others understand themselves, honor obligations accepted through any skin, adapt without erasing yourself, protect another person's concealed nature

Popular Anathema expose another person's natural form without consent, force someone to maintain an unwanted identity, use a remembrance to torment the deceased person's loved ones, treat an established identity as meaningless because its anatomy was borrowed

SAMPLE NAMES

Adrogall, Azusha, Cee, Ciribaán, Farahan, Leileeka, Miyleen, Sunikai, Xenelei, Zanilee

OTHER INFORMATION

ERBIUM INDUSTRIES MANDATE

Astrazoans employed by any branch of **Erbium Industries LLC** must receive a continuity identification node implanted along a central nerve nexus. The node remains detectable regardless of the skin the astrazoan currently wears and connects their changing appearance to a single corporate identity record.

Erbium-compatible systems can use the node to confirm the astrazoan's ancestry, employment status, registered service identities, remembrance authorizations, and node integrity. Erbium presents the mandate as necessary protection against identity fraud, unauthorized access, and misuse of remembrance skins.

The node also allows authorized systems to identify an astrazoan beneath a form that would otherwise pass every available visual, vocal, and biometric examination. Employees are not always informed when the node is queried or which information was retrieved.

Masking, removing, or falsifying a continuity node violates Settled Systems Code **A2%164-13**. An astrazoan found in violation may be placed under unverified continuity status, denied access to relay infrastructure, detained by corporate security, and prosecuted under the applicable continuity laws. Aggravated violations involving fatal harm or critical infrastructure may be referred for closure eligibility review.

REMEMBRANCE SERVICE

Early Settled Systems infrastructure relied heavily on biometric authentication. When credentialed technicians, administrators, owners, or officials died unexpectedly, disappeared, or were subjected to closure, essential systems sometimes became inaccessible.

Erbium Industries developed remembrance service as a solution. An astrazoan studies surviving medical scans, recordings, movement data, voice samples, work files, and behavioral records before assuming a skin that reproduces the absent person within the tolerances of the relevant authentication systems.

A remembrance does not contain the original person's consciousness or memories. It is a physical and behavioral reconstruction intended to satisfy machinery and personnel who expect that person to be present.

Remembrance service was initially restricted to emergencies involving life support, power generation, transportation, medical infrastructure, and intersystem relays. Erbium later expanded the practice to administrative access, contract continuity, proprietary research, asset authorization, and the long-term operation of legacy systems.

Modern Erbium employment agreements may grant the company limited rights to preserve an employee's biometric profile after death. The company describes remembrance service as a way for essential personnel to continue contributing to the Settled Systems. Critics describe it as a means of retaining a worker's body,

credentials, and labor after the worker is no longer alive to object.

Some astrazoans remain assigned to the same remembrance for years. They may occupy the deceased person's workstation, answer to their name, interact with their former coworkers, and operate systems that the company refuses to replace.

Families of the deceased have little consistent authority over the practice. Some find comfort in seeing a familiar face continue necessary work. Others experience the remembrance as a corporate imitation that prevents them from grieving. Erbium generally treats these objections as personal disputes unless they interfere with operations.

SHIFTING SKIN

Astrazoans transform through a coordinated somatic process that redistributes their organs, muscles, nervous tissue, and stored body mass. Their skin cells possess an adaptive quality that allows rapid control over pigmentation, texture, and surface structure.

Several research groups in the Settled Systems have attempted to reproduce these qualities in non-astrazoan bodies. The most advanced project produced a dermal augmentation capable of limited near-perfect physical mimicry.

The researchers claimed that all biological material used in the project was cultivated from voluntary, laboratory-grown samples. The program was suspended after investigators found incomplete consent records, mislabeled tissue archives, and samples collected during mandatory employee medical examinations.

Erbium Industries denies retaining any functional prototypes.

Rumors persist of **skin suits** used by intelligence personnel, private collectors, corporate infiltrators, and individuals wealthy enough to purchase another person's appearance. Astrazoans remain subject to mandatory continuity identification while the company responsible for enforcing that mandate continues to pursue proprietary shapeshifting technology.

FOUND FAMILIES

Many astrazoans develop strong attachments to the families and communities they join. Some spend most of their lives in a single established skin, becoming fully integrated into its relationships, traditions, and daily routines.

An astrazoan might raise children with members of another ancestry, inherit obligations from a community they joined, or remain in one body because it has become inseparable from the people who know them through it. Some never reveal their unassigned body, either because they see no need or because they fear that disclosure would change those relationships.

Other astrazoans move between communities and identities throughout their lives. Even those who regularly retire old skins often build found families from friends, coworkers, traveling companions, and rivals who learn to recognize the person across those changes.

Being shown an astrazoan's unassigned body can represent trust, vulnerability, or simple physical comfort. It is not necessarily a revelation of a more authentic self. The significance comes from being allowed to see the astrazoan without requiring them to assume a familiar or useful shape.

EIGHTH ARM BREAK

Astrazoans who abandon or permanently lose one of their established identities can experience a period of grief known as an **Eighth Arm Break**.

The name refers to an injury to the invisible continuity that joins an astrazoan's recurring selves rather than to the literal loss of an eighth limb. The event can follow severe physical injury, damage to an arm's neural network, rejection by a host community, or circumstances that make an established skin impossible to inhabit.

Within the Settled Systems, an Eighth Arm Break can also occur when a service identity is blacklisted, forcibly retired, exposed, or made legally unusable. Astrazoans assigned to remembrance service are especially vulnerable when a long-held remembrance is abruptly terminated or when the original identity becomes associated with scandal, criminal charges, or corporate closure.

Settled Systems records treat the loss as an administrative change. The astrazoan may experience it as the destruction of a meaningful part of their life.

The resulting grief can be intense, but some astrazoans use the experience to reconsider their relationship with their remaining selves or develop an identity free from earlier expectations. Certain communities regard an Eighth Arm Break as a possible rite of maturity, though few consider it something that should be deliberately inflicted.

For an astrazoan PC, permanently losing an established identity might invalidate ancestry feats or other options associated with that skin. The GM should allow the character to retrain affected ancestry options as part of the resulting story.

ASTRAZOAN MECHANICS

HIT POINTS

8

SIZE

Medium

SPEED

25 feet

ATTRIBUTE BOOSTS

Dexterity, Charisma, Free

ATTRIBUTE FLAW

Constitution

LANGUAGES

Common and one regional language of your choice.

Additional languages equal to your Intelligence modifier, if it is positive. Choose from the list of common languages and any other languages to which you have access, such as languages prevalent on your home world.

LOW-LIGHT VISION

You can see in dim light as though it were bright light, and you ignore the concealed condition caused by dim light.

CHANGE SHAPE ➡

| **ASTRAZOAN** **CONCENTRATE** **POLYMORPH**

You transform into a Small, Medium, or Large ancestry you know, choosing your body type, gender, and any other physical features within the ordinary range for that ancestry. The form can resemble a specific individual or be completely unique. Using Change Shape counts as creating a disguise for the Impersonate use of Deception. You can remain in the shape indefinitely and can return to your unassigned body or assume another shape by using this action again. If you die while using another shape, your body slowly returns to its unassigned form.

Temporary or improvised shapes use your normal ability modifiers. An established skin can instead possess a fixed ability profile as described below.

ESTABLISHED SKIN PROFILES

When you develop an established skin, you can reduce one of your ability modifiers other than Constitution by 1 and increase a different ability modifier other than Constitution by 1. The increased modifier cannot exceed the highest ability modifier you possessed before applying the skin's adjustments. The adjustment belongs

permanently to that established skin. Each time you assume it, use the same adjusted modifiers. Returning to your unassigned body or assuming a form without an established profile restores your normal modifiers.

Developing a new established skin or changing an existing skin's ability profile requires downtime and GM approval. A cosmetic alteration made during ordinary use of Change Shape does not create a new profile. These adjustments affect statistics normally calculated using the altered ability modifiers. They do not change your proficiency ranks, grant or remove languages, qualify you for character options, or alter other permanent choices made during character creation or advancement.

Because an established profile can change Armor Class, saving throws, attack modifiers, skill modifiers, spell statistics, Perception, damage, and other derived values, record each frequently used established skin on a separate character sheet or clearly marked statistics block.

Complex Character Option

An astrazoan with established skin profiles requires more bookkeeping than a typical ancestry. The player and GM should agree on the character's established skins and record their adjusted statistics before those forms are used during play.

Heritages

AQUAZOAN

Astrazoans occupying aquatic worlds and communities learn how to integrate gills and fins into their forms and can even manifest these traits when imitating species that do not normally have them. You gain a swim Speed of 20 feet, and you gain the **amphibious** trait, enabling you to breathe in water and air.

ASSIMILATED ASTRAZOAN

Whether you were raised as a member of another species or became fully immersed in their cultures and traditions later, you have completely assimilated to another ancestry and feel as comfortable in that skin as in your natural form. Choose a common ancestry. You can select ancestry feats from the ancestry you chose, in addition to your character's own ancestry. You can select feats that require a physiological feature that you lack but

can only benefit from those feats while you are in that ancestry's form; for example, an assimilated astrazoan who selects the shirren Basic Insectile Flight feat can only fly while in their shirren form.

CLONED ASTRAZOAN

You were either born in a laboratory using genetic samples preserved from a distant ancestor or budded from a parent astrazoan. Your body stubbornly refuses additional external attempts to change you. If you roll a success on a saving throw against a curse, disease, or **polymorph** effect, you get a critical success instead.

CONSTRUCT COPYCAT

You have reinforced your body with technological augmentations that can be shifted to give yourself the appearance of a constructed creature. You can use Change Shape to assume the appearance of a Small or Medium construct. You gain the **Augmented Body** general feat.

WILD ASTRAZOAN

While most astrazoans flock to communities in densely populated settlements, some choose to live among nature in the wilderness, forging their own destiny or even defending their paradise from the influence of others. You have only one ancestry you can select for Change Shape, but you can also use Change Shape to transform into an animal with the statistics of a 1st-rank **pest form**.